Six Big Bird plush options ready for a Raspberry Pi makeover

The best overall pick is a **Build-A-Bear Big Bird on eBay for ~$23 shipped** — it's literally designed to be opened and re-stuffed. But the ideal choice depends on how much interior space you need and how much you want to spend. Below are six options spanning $20–$90 and 20–41 inches, all confirmed as the genuine Sesame Street Big Bird character, sourced from eBay, Etsy, and a specialty retailer.

A key finding: currently-produced Big Bird plush from major retailers (Walmart, Target, Amazon) max out at **14–17 inches** for standard models. Macys +2 To hit the 20"+ requirement, you're mostly looking at **vintage/secondhand plush, bundle packs, or specialty sellers** carrying older GUND stock. That's actually good news for this project — vintage plush tends to be larger, softer, and cheaper than new production.

Option 1: Build-A-Bear Big Bird, 22" (eBay) — best for modification

- **Product:** Build A Bear Sesame Street Large Big Bird 22" Plush Stuffed Animal (2006 limited edition) eBay
- **Size:** 22 inches
- **Price:** $14.97 + $7.57 shipping = **~$22.54 total** (Best Offer accepted)
- **Seller/Platform:** eBay — "Vintage Kansas" (6,456 feedback, 99.8% positive, Top Rated Plus) ebay
- **URL:** https://www.ebay.com/itm/146107070229
- **Condition:** Used — described as "excellent, no stains, no flaws, no smells" ebay
- **Modification notes: This is the #1 recommendation for hiding electronics inside.** Build-A-Bear plush toys are specifically designed with a simple back seam meant to be opened and re-stuffed. The closure stitch can be undone without cutting, the interior is loose polyester fiberfill with no rigid frame, and the body cavity is spacious and accessible. A Raspberry Pi 5, small speaker, and cabling would fit comfortably. Re-stitching the back seam is trivial. At ~$23 shipped, it's the best value on this list.

⚠️ *Listing shows 1 person has it in their cart and 3 watchers — may sell quickly.*

Option 2: Vintage 24" pull-string talking Big Bird (eBay) — built-in electronics cavity

- **Product:** Sesame Street Big Bird 24 Inch Plush with Pull String (vintage talking plush)
- **Size:** 24 inches
- **Price:** $13.50 + $11.20 shipping = ~**$24.70 total** (Best Offer accepted)
- **Seller/Platform:** eBay — "pinkpeonythrift" (111 feedback, 100% positive) eBay
- **URL:** https://www.ebay.com/itm/225418990912
- **Condition:** Used — cosmetic wear noted: "left eye discolored, stain on one tail feather, fabric worn in mouth" eBay
- **Modification notes:** The standout feature here is that this plush **already has an internal cavity** from the original pull-string voice box mechanism. Remove the old voice box, and you have a pre-formed pocket sized for electronics — no need to carve out space in the stuffing. The cosmetic imperfections are irrelevant for a mod project and keep the price low. Standard soft polyester body, easy to cut and re-sew. At 24 inches, it comfortably meets the size target with room for all components.

💡 *The existing voice-box compartment is a significant advantage — it provides a ready-made housing for the Raspberry Pi.*

Option 3: New handmade Big Bird, 20" (eBay) — cheapest option

- **Product:** Big Bird Plush Toy From Sesame Street 20 inches (handmade)
- **Size:** 20 inches
- **Price: $19.99 with free shipping**
- **Seller/Platform:** eBay — "pocho_9823" (30 feedback, 100% positive)
- **URL:** https://www.ebay.com/itm/357683409820
- **Condition:** New (handmade)
- **Modification notes:** This is the cheapest option on the list and ships from Phoenix, Arizona — close to Claremont for fast delivery. Being handmade, the stitching may actually be easier to open than factory plush. Standard soft polyester fill throughout, no rigid parts. The main tradeoff is size: at exactly **20 inches, this is the minimum acceptable height**, and much of that goes to legs and head/beak. The torso cavity will be tighter than larger options. A Raspberry Pi 5 and small speaker should still fit, but cable routing will require more planning. Best if budget is the primary concern.

Option 4: Vintage 1985 Playskool Big Bird, 31" (eBay) — maximum space on a budget

- **Product:** VINTAGE 31" Big Bird Plush 1985 Playskool Official Sesame Street Collectible
- **Size: 31 inches** (categorized as "Large 24–36 in")
- **Price:** $44.99 + $7.41 shipping = ~**$52.40 total**
- **Seller/Platform:** eBay — "CLB Thrift" / bowman_enterprises (3,938 feedback, 100% positive)
- **URL:** https://www.ebay.com/itm/146371108234
- **Condition:** Used — vintage 1985 Playskool, made in Korea ebay
- **Modification notes:** At **31 inches, this provides an enormous internal cavity** — easily enough room for a Raspberry Pi 5, speaker, cables, and even a battery pack with space to spare. Vintage 1980s Playskool plush is entirely soft polyester fiberfill with no rigid internal armature. The fabric shell uses simple seam stitching that's straightforward to open and re-close. Being 40 years old, the fabric may be slightly softer/more pliable than new plush, which actually makes modification easier. This is the best option if you want maximum interior volume without spending $90.

Option 5: Hasbro Softies 30" Big Bird (Etsy) — softest construction

- **Product:** Hasbro Softies Vintage 1980s Sesame Street Big Bird 30"
- **Size: 30 inches**
- **Price: $59.99 with free shipping**
- **Seller/Platform:** Etsy — seller with 924 reviews
- **URL:** https://www.etsy.com/listing/4467563121/hasbro-softies-vintage-1980s-sesame
- **Condition:** Used/Vintage (1980s Hasbro Softies line)
- **Modification notes:** The Hasbro "Softies" line is named for exactly what it is — **extremely soft, floppy, loosely-stuffed plush** designed to be maximally huggable. The construction is essentially a polyester fabric shell filled with loose polyester fiberfill and nothing else. No rigid structures, no plastic components, no internal wire frames. This makes it arguably the easiest plush on this list to modify: the loose fill can be partially removed by hand, electronics placed inside, and the seam re-stitched. The 30-inch size provides generous interior volume. At $59.99 with free shipping, it sits right at the top of the stated budget.

Option 6: GUND Jumbo Big Bird, 41" (Midtown Comics) — the premium choice

- **Product:** Gund Sesame Street Large Plush — Big Bird 41-Inch
- **Size: 41 inches** (over 3 feet tall)
- **Price: $89.99** (shipping additional)
- **Seller/Platform:** Midtown Comics (specialty comic/collectibles retailer, NYC-based, ships nationally)
- **URL:** https://www.midtowncomics.com/product/1155471
- **Condition:** New
- **UPC:** 028399759279 Midtown Comics
- **Modification notes:** This is the largest and highest-quality option. Made by **GUND**, the leading US soft toy manufacturer, Amazon midtowncomics from polyester blend Midtown Comics plush Midtown Comics with fabric eyes (no hard plastic parts). At 41 inches, the interior volume is massive — you could fit the Raspberry Pi 5, speaker, cables, a battery pack, and still have room for stuffing to maintain the plush feel. Entertainment Earth Being brand-new, the materials are in perfect condition for clean cuts and tight re-stitching. The tradeoff is price: at $89.99, it's well above the $20–60 range, but if the project demands maximum space and a pristine starting point, this is the one.

Quick-reference comparison

#	Size	Total price	Platform	Condition	Key advantage
1	22"	~$23	eBay	Used	Designed to be opened (Build-A-Bear)
2	24"	~$25	eBay	Used	Pre-existing electronics cavity
3	20"	$20	eBay	New	Cheapest, free shipping
4	31"	~$52	eBay	Vintage	Huge interior, great price-to-size ratio
5	30"	$60	Etsy	Vintage	Extremely soft, easy to modify
6	41"	$90	Midtown Comics	New	Massive, premium quality

What I'd actually buy for this project

For hiding a Raspberry Pi 5, small speaker, and cables, **Option 1 (Build-A-Bear, ~$23)** is the clear winner on value — it's designed to be opened, costs almost nothing, and 22 inches provides adequate space if you remove enough fill. If you want more breathing room for components and cable routing, **Option 4 (31" Playskool, ~$52)** offers nearly double the interior volume for only $30 more and stays within budget. The vintage pull-string Big Bird (Option 2) deserves special mention: its **factory-built voice box compartment** is essentially a ready-made electronics bay that could save significant modification time. All six options have soft polyester bodies that can be cut open and re-stitched with basic sewing skills.